Botan Buran

Department of Political Science, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA
Langdale Hall 1011, Atlanta, GA 30303
bburan1@gsu.edu | botan.buran.github.io

Education

Georgia State University Atlanta, GA
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science 2022–2027 (expected)

- Dissertation: *The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power*
- Committee: Dan Altman (Chair), Louis-Alexandre Berg, and William Long.
- Comprehensive exams: International Relations (major), Political Methodology (minor)

TOBB University of Economics and Technology Ankara, Turkey
M.A. International Relations 2021

- Thesis: *Threat and Underbalancing: A Neoclassical Realist Analysis of Turkey's Iran Policy During the Ahmadinejad Period (2005–2013)*
- Advisor: Şaban Kardaş

Sakarya University Sakarya, Turkey
B.A. International Relations 2018

Work In Progress

Buran, Botan. *The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power* (in progress)

Buran, Botan. "The Market for Patrons: External Protection and Limits of Regional Balancing." (in progress)

Buran, Botan. "The Myth of Regional Hegemony." (in progress)

Buran, Botan. "Does Balancing or Bandwagoning Predominate? A New Approach to an Old Question." (in progress)

Buran, Botan and Şaban Kardaş. "Revisiting the Saudi Reaction to the 'Iranian Threat': A Case of Overbalancing?" (email for draft)

Buran, Botan and Şaban Kardaş. "Threat and Underbalancing: Analysis of Turkey's Iran Policy During the Ahmadinejad Era." (email for draft)

Buran, Botan. "Good Authoritarian and Bad Authoritarian: Are Personalist Regimes Reliable Allies?" (in progress)

Buran, Botan and Efe Can Çoban. "Differentiating the Military Interventions: Effects on Democracy in Turkey." (in progress)

Teaching Experience

Georgia State University

- Introduction to American Government, POLS 1101 (Instructor, Fall 2026)
- Introduction to American Government, POLS 1101 – Simulcast (Teaching Assistant, Fall 2026)
- Introduction to American Government, POLS 1101 (Instructor, Summer 2026)
- Global Studies, POLS 2401 (Instructor, Spring 2024)
- Interdisciplinary Approaches to Research, GLOS 3000 / INDS 3000 (Teaching Assistant, Spring 2023)
- U.S. Foreign Policy, POLS 3450 (Teaching Assistant, Spring 2023)
- Introduction to American Government, POLS 1101 (Teaching Assistant, Fall 2022)

Grants, Fellowships, & Awards

APSA Travel Grant | $400 — Fall 2026

ISA Travel Grant | $600 — Spring 2026

GSU Department of Political Science Travel Grant | $250 — Fall 2025
For presentation at APSA.

GSU Department of Political Science Travel Grant | $250 — Fall 2025
For presentation at IS-ISSS.

GSU Political Science Summer Research & Professional Development Fellowship | $2,600 — 2024
Awarded to support methodological training at the ICPSR Summer Program.

GSU Department of Political Science Travel Grant | $250 — Spring 2024
For presentation at the Gulf Studies Symposium, Georgetown University.

Professional Experience

Graduate Student Association, Georgia State University
President — Aug. 2025– Aug. 2026
Lead the graduate student organization and represent graduate student interests.

Department of Political Science, Georgia State University
Website and Social Media Manager — Sept. 2024–Present
Manage the department's online presence and digital communications.

Graduate Student Association, Georgia State University
Professional Development Chair — Aug. 2023–Aug. 2024
Organized professional development events, workshops, and networking opportunities for graduate students.

Gulf Data Project, Qatar University
Project Management Assistant (Remote) — Sept.–Nov. 2021
Collected large-N data on Qatari and Emirati foreign aid; assisted with project coordination and data management.

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA) — 2026
"The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power"

International Studies Association Annual Convention (ISA) — 2026
"The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power"

ISA International Security Studies Section & ISSS Annual Conference (IS-ISSS) — 2025
"The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power"

Gulf Studies Symposium, Georgetown University — 2024
"Revisiting the Saudi Reaction to the 'Iranian Threat': A Case of Overbalancing?" (with Şaban Kardaş)

International Studies Association–South Annual Conference (ISA-South) — 2023
"The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power"

Atlanta Symposium on Political Science (ASOPS) — 2023
"The Myth of the Regional Balance of Power"

ISA International Security Studies Section & ISSS Annual Conference (IS-ISSS) — 2022
"Threat and Underbalancing: Analysis of Turkey's Iran Policy During the Ahmadinejad Era"

Training

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research — 2024
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. Courses: Bayesian Modeling for the Social Sciences I: Introduction and Application (EITM Certification, A+); Introduction to Time Series and Panel Data Analysis (EITM Certification, A); Causal Inference for the Social Sciences (audited).

Languages & Skills

Languages: Turkish (native), English (fluent), Italian (beginner), Kurdish (beginner).
Software: R, LaTeX, NVivo, MS Office, Loom, Kaltura.

References

Dan Altman *Dissertation Chair*
Associate Professor of Political Science, Georgia State University
daltman@gsu.edu

Louis-Alexandre Berg *Committee Member*
Associate Professor of Political Science, Georgia State University
lberg@gsu.edu

William Long *Committee Member*
Professor of Political Science, Georgia State University
long@gsu.edu

Şaban Kardaş *M.A. Advisor & Co-author*
Professor of Political Science, Qatar University
sabankardas@gmail.com

Updated September 2026